

5 Portions A Day TO KEEP DOCTORS AWAY

An apple a day is no longer enough. Make it five servings of fruits and vegetables a day if you want to be in the pink of health. Here's how to disguise them in your meals.

FIVE A DAY

The World Health Organisation claims that 50 per cent of adult lifestyle diseases—from cancer to heart attacks—are related to nutritional deficiencies, many of which can be rectified by eating five portions of fruit and vegetables a day. It's easier said than done. How does one incorporate so much fruit and vegetable into one's diet every day? And what does one portion mean, anyway? Here's a smart chart that will help you pep up your daily meals with the goodness of fruits and vegetables.



PORTION 2 Snack time

One portion=take one heaped tablespoon of raisins or three dried apricots for mid-morning snacking or one cupful of grapes or berries or keep a piece of fresh fruit at hand and ensure you eat it before you reach for high-sugar snacks.



PORTION 1 Breakfast

One portion=a small glass (150ml) of fresh, unsweetened orange juice or some fresh fruit slices or a handful of raisins with breakfast cereals or a fresh fruit smoothie. You can add skimmed milk or low fat yogurt for a more creamy consistency.

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CALORIES ARE WHAT YOU GET IN A PORTION OF FRUIT OR VEGETABLES. OR FIVE POTATO CRISPS. GO FRUITY TO STAY LEAN.

PORTION 3 Lunch

One portion=try a side salad with lunch. Or make a sandwich thick with tomatoes, carrots and salad leaves (tomatoes reduce the risk of lung cancer, carrots lower cholesterol and salad leaves help prevent cataracts). Or try a cup of vegetable soup.



PORTION 4 Dinner

One portion=include at least, one vegetable with your evening meal. Add sliced vegetables to stir fries (remember, just one gram of onion a day is enough to take care of your bone health); or try three heaped tablespoons of vegetables, beans or pulses with dinner.

PORTION 5 Dessert

One portion=a fresh fruit salad or one dessert bowl of salad; have melons or fresh pineapple or strawberries as dessert.



DAILY DOSE

Minor infections, colds and the flu are less likely if you eat plenty of fruits and vegetables, particularly berries, red peppers and citrus fruits. They offer the best way to get high levels of vitamin C in your diet. Research shows that people with high intakes of vitamin C have 34 per cent fewer sick days than others.

■ Compiled by **Damayanti Datta**